(4) No fees may be charged for use or distribution of the data. All persons are granted a limited license to use and distribute these data, but you may not charge a fee for the data if you distribute them to others.

(5) Cite the MEPS appropriately. Publications and research reports based on the database must cite it appropriately. Please see http://www.meps.ipums.org/meps/citation.shtml

(6) MEPS cannot be used to study small geographic areas. The smallest geographical areas identified in the MEPS are regions (groups of states) and a limited number of metropolitan areas.

(7) This system provides individual-level data only. The MEPS Data Extraction System will not produce tables. You will need to use a statistical software package, such as Stata, SAS, or SPSS, to analyze the downloaded data. Alternatively, you may use the MEPS-SDA tabulator to produce tables online, without making a data extract.

Disclaimer

The user of the data acknowledges that the original collector of the data, the authorized distributor of the data, and the relevant funding agency bear no responsibility for use of the data or for interpretations or inferences based upon such uses.

Study Notes

Notes	
Note:	User-provided description: Preliminary/exploratory data on adults with insurance and ED expenditure in 2020

§ 3. File Description

File

File Name:	meps_00002.dat
Contents of Files:	Microdata records
Type:	rectangular
File Type:	ISO-8859-1 data file
Data Format:	fixed length fields
Place of File Production:	IPUMS, 50 Willey Hall, 225 - 19th Avenue South, Minneapolis, MN 55455

§ 4. Variable Description

Jump to Variable

1. YEAR (Survey year)
2. PERNUM (Person number within family/household (from reformatting))
3. DUID (Dwelling unit ID)

4. PID (Person number)
5. MEPSID (MEPS unique identifier (IPUMS generated))
6. PANEL (Panel)
7. PSUANN (Annual primary sampling unit (PSU) for variance estimation)
8. STRATANN (Annual stratum for variance estimation)
9. PSUPLD (Pooled primary sampling unit (PSU) for variance estimation)
10. STRATAPLD (Pooled variance stratum)
11. PANELYR (Year entered MEPS)
12. RELYR (Relative year 1 or 2 in panel)
13. PERWEIGHT (Final basic annual weight)
14. SAQWEIGHT (Self-Administered Questionnaire weight)
15. DIABWEIGHT (Diabetes care weight)
16. AGE (Age)
17. SEX (Sex)
18. RACEA (Main Racial Background (Pre-1997 Revised OMB Standards), self-reported or interviewer reported)
19. HEALTH (Health status)
20. USUALPL (Has usual place for medical care)
21. HINOTCOV (Has no health insurance (excluding single service plans))
22. HIPRIVATE (Has any private health insurance)
23. HIMACHIP (Covered by Medicaid and/or SCHIP)
24. ARTHGLUPEV (Ever told had arthritis/rheumatoid arthritis/gout/lupus/fibromyalgia)
25. CANCEREV (Ever told had cancer)
26. CHEARTDIEV (Ever told had coronary heart disease)
27. DIABETICEV (Ever told had diabetes)
28. HEARTATTEV (Ever told had heart attack)
29. PHQDEP (Feeling down, depressed, or hopeless: past two weeks)
30. EXPTOT (Annual total of direct health care payments)
31. EREXPTOT (Annual total of direct health care payments for emergency room visits)
32. HPTOTDIS (Annual total number of hospital discharges)
33. DVEXPTOT (Sum of expenditures for dental care received during the year)
34. ADPALS (Accomplished less because of physical health: past 4 weeks)
35. PHQ2 (PHQ-2 depression screen summary score)

Variable: "YEAR"

Name:	YEAR
Label:	Survey year
Variable Text:	YEAR is a four-digit variable reporting the calendar year (e.g., 2003) the survey was conducted and the data were collected. YEAR indicates the survey year on the person record.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	1

End Position:	4
Width:	4
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0
Coder Instructions:	This is a 4-digit numeric variable with 0 implied decimal places

Variable: "PERNUM"

Name:	PERNUM
Label:	Person number within family/household (from reformatting)
Variable Text:	PERNUM is an IPUMS MEPS-constructed variable that numbers all persons within each household consecutively (starting with "1") in the order in which they appear in the original MEPS data. PERNUM was created by IPUMS MEPS during the process of reformatting the original MEPS public use files.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	5
End Position:	6
Width:	2
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0
Coder Instructions:	CodesPERNUM is a 2-digit numeric variable.

Variable: "DUID"

Name:	DUID
Label:	Dwelling unit ID
Variable Text:	For all persons, DUID reports the identifier assigned by MEPS to the person's Dwelling Unit (DU), sampled for MEPS data collection. DUID is a random ID number assigned after the DU was sampled for MEPS and does not change once assigned. The MEPS sample is a subset of the households that participated in the National Health Interview Survey

	(NHIS). DU definitions are generally consistent with NHIS definitions of households. For example, the 2018 NHIS Survey Description document describes households as "occupied housing units" (p. 10) that exclude "long-term care institutions (for example, nursing homes for the elderly, hospitals for the chronically ill or physically or intellectually disabled, and wards for abused or neglected children), correctional facilities (for example, prisons or jails, juvenile detention centers, and halfway houses)." (p. 8). Additionally, "unless one other family member is a civilian eligible for the survey (for example, a child whose parents are both active-duty military)" (p. 8), housing units occupied by active-duty Armed Forces personnel are also excluded from the survey. From 1996-2017, DUID is unique within panel, but must be combined with PANEL to be unique across panels. Starting in 2018, DUID begins with the 2-digit variable PANEL, making DUID unique across panels. DUID can be combined with PID to uniquely identify each person within the Dwelling Unit. Please see the user note for more information on the relationship between Dwelling Units, families, Reporting Units, and persons.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	7
End Position:	13
Width:	7
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0
Coder Instructions:	DUID is a numeric variable ranging in width from 1 to 7 digits.

Variable: "PID"

Name:	PID
Label:	Person number
Variable Text:	For all persons, PID is a within-Dwelling Unit (DU) person identifier assigned in sampling or by the computer-assisted personal interviewing (CAPI) instrument. PID must be combined with DUID and PANEL to uniquely identify persons across all MEPS data. IPUMS MEPS offers the constructed variable MEPSID, created by concatenating the values of DUID, PID, and PANEL. Please see the user note for more information on the relationship between Dwelling Units, families, Reporting Units, and persons.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	14

End Position:	16
Width:	3
Variable Format:	character
Implied Decimal Places:	0
Coder Instructions:	CodesPID is a 3-digit numeric variable.

Variable: "MEPSID"

Name:	MEPSID
Label:	MEPS unique identifier (IPUMS generated)
Variable Text:	For all persons, MEPSID is a variable that uniquely identifies respondents across MEPS panels. It is created by combining PANEL, DUID, and PID. IPUMS MEPS staff create MEPSID for the 1996-2017 samples to provide a single, universal linking key for MEPS persons. Beginning in 2018, AHRQ modified the identifiers DUID and DUPERSID (which combines DUID with PID) on the original MEPS data files to append information about PANEL to the first two columns. This update makes DUPERSID identical to MEPSID in the IPUMS MEPS extract system for 2018-forward. In earlier versions of IPUMS MEPS, IPUMS MEPS staff created a slightly different version of MEPSID, equivalent to combining DUID, PID, and PANEL. This version has been renamed to MEPSID2 and is only available for 1996-2017.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	17
End Position:	26
Width:	10
Variable Format:	character
Implied Decimal Places:	0
Coder Instructions:	This is a 10-digit numeric variable with 0 implied decimal places

Variable: "PANEL"

Name:	PANEL

Label:	Panel
Variable Text:	For all persons, PANEL reports the number of the panel of which the person was a member. MEPS began in 1996 with Panel number 1 and the panel number for persons entering the MEPS in each subsequent year increases by 1, so that 1997 had Panels 1 (the panel that entered in 1996, in their second year in 1997) and 2 (the panel newly entering MEPS in 1997), 1998 had Panels 2 and 3, 1999 had Panels 3 and 4, and so on. PANEL can be combined with DUID and PID to uniquely identify individuals across panels. IPUMS MEPS offers the constructed variable MEPSID that is equal to the concatenated values of DUID, PID, and PANEL. For more information on the relationship between calendar year, panel, and round data, please see the IPUMS MEPS Panel Design Documentation.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	27
End Position:	28
Width:	2
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
00	
01	
02	
03	
04	
05	
06	
07	

08	
09	
10	
11	
12	
13	
14	
15	
16	
17	
18	
19	
20	
21	
22	
23	
24	
25	

Variable: "PSUANN"

Name:	PSUANN
Label:	Annual primary sampling unit (PSU) for variance estimation
Variable Text:	PSUANN is the annual primary sampling unit variable that represents the impact of sample design clustering on the estimates of variance and standard errors. It is appropriate to use PSUANN to generate annual estimates for all years. For pooled analyses including years before 2002 or after 2018, analysts should instead use the pooled primary sampling unit variable, PSUPLD. For analyses limited to years 2002-2018, PSUANN is suitable for use in annual and pooled analyses. PSUANN is constant within a sample design period and changes between sample design periods. For analysis, researchers need to use PSUANN in conjunction with STRATANN to

	account for stratification and clustering when computing variance estimates with IPUMS MEPS data.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	29
End Position:	31
Width:	3
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0
Coder Instructions:	CodesPSUANN is a 3-digit numeric variable. 000: Not in Universe

Variable: "STRATANN"

Name:	STRATANN
Label:	Annual stratum for variance estimation
Variable Text:	STRATANN is the annual sampling strata that represents the impact of sample design stratification on the estimates of variance and standard errors. It is appropriate to use STRATANN to generate annual estimates for all years. For pooled analyses including years before 2002 or after 2018, analysts should instead use the pooled variance sampling strata variable, STRATAPLD. For analyses limited to years 2002-2018, STRATANN is suitable for use in annual and pooled analyses. From 1996-2001 and 2019 forward, STRATANN were statistically independent from year to year. From 2002-2018, strata are constant within sample design period. For analysis, researchers need to use STRATANN in conjunction with PSUANN to account for stratification and clustering when computing variance estimates with MEPS data.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	32
End Position:	35
Width:	4
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal	0

Places:	
Coder Instructions:	CodesSTRATANN is a 4-digit numeric variable. 0000: Not in Universe

Variable: "PSUPLD"

Name:	PSUPLD
Label:	Pooled primary sampling unit (PSU) for variance estimation
Variable Text:	PSUPLD is the pooled variance primary sampling unit variable that represents the impact of the sample design clustering on the estimates of variance and standard errors. It is appropriate to use PSUPLD instead of the annual primary sampling unit (PSUANN) if the years included in a pooled analysis include survey years 1996-2001 or 2019-forward. When pooling data from only 2002-2018, it is appropriate to use the variable PSUANN, the annual stratum variable for each survey year. For analysis, researchers need to use PSUPLD in conjunction with STRATAPLD to account for stratification and clustering when computing variance estimates with IPUMS MEPS data. PSUPLD should be used when analysts wish to pool together (aka combine) more than one year of MEPS annual data including any years before 2002 or after 2018. In most years, MEPS samples are not completely independent from one another, both because each panel is in the MEPS for two consecutive years and because households are sampled from the same geographic areas in multiple years. However, because MEPS is designed to be nationally representative in every year, multiple sample years can still be pooled. The use of PSUPLD and STRAPLD is necessary to obtain appropriate standard errors by specifying a common variance structure.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	36
End Position:	36
Width:	1
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0
Coder Instructions:	CodesPSUPLD is a 1-digit numeric variable. 0: Not in Universe

Variable: "STRATAPLD"

Name:	STRATAPLD

Label:	Pooled variance stratum
Variable Text:	STRATAPLD is the pooled variance sampling strata variable that represents the impact of the sample design stratification on the estimates of variance and standard errors. It is appropriate to use STRATAPLD instead of the annual strata variable (STRATANN) if the years included in a pooled analysis include survey years 1996-2001 or 2019-forward. For pooling data from only 2002-2018, it is appropriate to use the variable STRATANN. For analysis, researchers need to use STRATAPLD in conjunction with PSUPLD to account for stratification and clustering when computing variance estimates with IPUMS MEPS data. STRATAPLD should be used when users wish to pool together (aka combine) more than one year of MEPS annual data including any years before 2002 or after 2018. In most years, MEPS samples are not completely independent from one another, both because each panel is in the MEPS for two consecutive years and because households are sampled from the same geographic areas in multiple years. However, because MEPS is designed to be nationally representative in every year, multiple sample years can still be pooled. The use of STRATAPLD and PSUPLD is necessary to obtain appropriate standard errors by specifying a common variance structure.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	37
End Position:	40
Width:	4
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0
Coder Instructions:	CodesSTRATAPLD is a 4-digit numeric variable. 0000: Not in Universe

Variable: "PANELYR"

Name:	PANELYR
Label:	Year entered MEPS
Variable Text:	For all persons, PANELYR reports the year that the person started to participate in the MEPS Household Component interviews. PANELYR is identical to YEAR if the person is in their first year of MEPS participation ("relative year 1," captured in RELYR), or the year previous to the one recorded in YEAR if the person is in relative year 2 of the MEPS PANEL. For more information on the relationship between relative year, calendar year, panel, and round data, please see the IPUMS MEPS Panel Design Documentation.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON

Start Position:	41
End Position:	44
Width:	4
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
1996	1996
1997	1997
1998	1998
1999	1999
2000	2000
2001	2001
2002	2002
2003	2003
2004	2004
2005	2005
2006	2006
2007	2007
2008	2008
2009	2009
2010	2010

2011	2011
2012	2012
2013	2013
2014	2014
2015	2015
2016	2016
2017	2017
2018	2018
2019	2019
2020	2020

Variable: "RELYR"

Name:	RELYR
Label:	Relative year 1 or 2 in panel
Variable Text:	For all persons, RELYR indicates whether they are in their first or second year of participation in the MEPS household component panel. The MEPS panel involves five rounds of interviews over a period of about two years. For more information on the relationship between relative year, calendar year, panel, and round data, please see the IPUMS MEPS Panel Design Documentation.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	45
End Position:	45
Width:	1
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0
Categories	

Value	Label
1	Relative year 1
2	Relative year 2
3	Relative year 3

Variable: "PERWEIGHT"

Name:	PERWEIGHT
Label:	Final basic annual weight
Variable Text:	PERWEIGHT is an IPUMS MEPS-constructed variable based on the Final Person Weight in the original MEPS annual full-year consolidated files. This weight should be used for many cross-sectional analyses at the person level, particularly with variables for which information was collected about all family members. PERWEIGHT represents the inverse probability of selection into the sample, adjusted for non-response with post-stratification adjustments for age, race/ethnicity, and sex using the Census Bureau's population control totals. For each year, the sum of these weights is equal to that year's civilian, non-institutionalized U.S. population. There are instances, however, when the researcher should use a different person-level weight, particularly when analyzing variables from the Self-Administered Questionnaire or the Diabetes Care Survey, or when conducting longitudinal analyses with the MEPS data. For example, researchers analyzing variables from the Self-Administered Questionnaire from 2000 forward should use SAQWEIGHT rather than PERWEIGHT. Users should review the documentation for extracted variables--most notably the "Weights" section toward the top of each variable description--to ascertain which weight is the appropriate choice for a given survey year.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	46
End Position:	57
Width:	12
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	6
Coder Instructions:	CodesPERWEIGHT is a 12-digit numeric variable with 6 implied decimals.

Variable: "SAQWEIGHT"

Name:	SAQWEIGHT
Label:	Self-Administered Questionnaire weight
Variable Text:	SAQWEIGHT is an IPUMS MEPS-constructed variable based on the Final SAQ Weight in the original MEPS annual full-year consolidated files. This weight should be used for many cross-sectional analyses at the person level, particularly with variables for which information was collected about persons selected for the Self-Administered Questionnaire (SAQ) (see SAQELIG for the person's SAQ eligibility status). For each year, the sum of these weights is equal to that year's civilian, non-institutionalized U.S. population aged 18 and older. SAQWEIGHT adjusts for SAQ non-response. In 2000, SAQWEIGHT also includes weighting information for children under the age of 18 whose parent or guardian completed the Parent Administered Questionnaire (PAQ). For 2000 only, the sum of SAQWEIGHT is equal to the full civilian, non-institutionalized U.S. population. SAQWEIGHT does differ from PERWEIGHT in 2000 because the poststratification age group of 15-19 was partitioned into two groups, 15-17 and 18-19, for SAQWEIGHT to account for the target populations of the SAQ and PAQ. Users should review the documentation for extracted variables, most notably the "Weights" section toward the top of each variable description, to ascertain which weight is the appropriate choice for a given survey year. See the User Notes on the use of sampling weights for additional information.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	58
End Position:	69
Width:	12
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	6
Coder Instructions:	CodesSAQWEIGHT is a 12-digit numeric variable with 6 implied decimal places. That is, values of 012345678912 should be interpreted as 12345.678912. The command files delivered with IPUMS extracts automatically divide SAQWEIGHT by 1,000,000, so no further adjustment is needed.

Variable: "DIABWEIGHT"

Name:	DIABWEIGHT
Label:	Diabetes care weight

Variable Text:	For all persons, DIABWEIGHT is an IPUMS MEPS-constructed variable based on the Final Diabetes Care Supplement Weight in the original MEPS annual full-year consolidated files. This weight should be used for many cross-sectional analyses at the person level, particularly with variables for which information was collected about persons selected for the self-administered Diabetes Care Survey (DCS) (individuals who reported that they had ever been told by a health care professional that they had diabetes). DIABWEIGHT adjusts for DCS non-response. For each year, the sum of these weights is equal to that year's estimated U.S. population of civilian, non-institutionalized diabetics aged 18 and older. Only persons who answer "yes" to DCSDIABDX have a positive value for DIABWEIGHT. For more information about the DCS, please see the Diabetes Care Survey user note. Users should review the documentation for extracted variables--most notably the "Weights" section toward the top of each variable description--to ascertain which weight is the appropriate choice for a given survey year.
Concept:	Technical Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	70
End Position:	81
Width:	12
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	6
Coder Instructions:	CodesDIABWEIGHT is a 12-digit numeric variable with 6 implied decimal places. That is, a value of 012345678912 should be interpreted as 12345.678912. The command files delivered with IPUMS extracts automatically divide DIABWEIGHT by 1,000,000, so no further adjustment is needed.

Variable: "AGE"

Name:	AGE
Label:	Age
Variable Text:	AGE reports the individual's exact age, calculated from date of birth, as of the last day (12/31) of the survey year. Date of birth and age were asked for each reporting unit member, and then exact age was calculated from date of birth. Where the calculated age and the age provided did not match, inconsistencies were reviewed and resolved. When date of birth was not provided, but age was provided, the month and year of birth were assigned randomly from among the possible valid options. For any cases still not accounted, age was imputed using: (1) the mean age difference between MEPS participants with certain family relationships (where available) or (2) the mean age value for MEPS participants.

Concept:	Core Demographic Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	82
End Position:	84
Width:	3
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0
Coder Instructions:	CodesAGE is a 3-digit-numeric variable. 085: Top code for 85 years or older (2001-forward) 090: Top code for 90 years or older (1996-2000) 996: Missing

Variable: "SEX"

Name:	SEX
Label:	Sex
Variable Text:	SEX indicates whether the person was male or female. Collection of information on SEX in MEPS Data on the sex of each reporting unit (RU) member was determined during the NHIS interview, and was then verified, and, if necessary, corrected during each MEPS interview. If the respondent was a new RU member or their sex was not ascertained in the NHIS interview, MEPS initially used the first name of the respondent to assign their sex. If the first name gave no clear indication of sex, the reported family relationships were used to assign sex. If the sex of the respondent was still unclear, sex was randomly assigned. The NHIS method of ascertaining the sex of the respondent, which primarily informs the MEPS version of SEX, is similar to the MEPS method. First, sex of the respondent was inferred from the individual's first name or family relationships. If the sex of the respondent was unclear, the interviewer was instructed to explicitly ask the person's sex. Beginning in 1998, interviewers were told to "enter your best guess" when the respondent either did not know or refused to answer the direct question that was asked about the person's sex.
Concept:	Core Demographic Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	85
End Position:	85
Width:	1

Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
1	Male
2	Female
7	Unknown-refused
8	Unknown-not ascertained
9	Unknown-don't know

Variable: "RACEA"

Name:	RACEA
Label:	Main Racial Background (Pre-1997 Revised OMB Standards), self-reported or interviewer reported
Variable Text:	RACEA reports the race of the respondent. If not ascertained, the race and/or ethnicity were assigned based on relationship to other members of the DU using a priority ordering that gave precedence to blood relatives in the immediate family.
Concept:	Ethnicity/Nativity Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	86
End Position:	88
Width:	3
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
100	White
200	Black/African-American
300	Aleut, Alaskan Native, or American Indian
310	Alaskan Native or American Indian
320	Alaskan Native/Eskimo
330	Aleut
340	American Indian
350	American Indian or Alaskan Native and any other group
400	Asian or Pacific Islander
410	Asian
411	Chinese
412	Filipino
413	Korean
414	Vietnamese
415	Japanese
416	Asian Indian
420	Pacific Islander
421	Hawaiian
422	Samoan
423	Guamanian
430	Other Asian or Pacific Islander
431	Other Asian or Pacific Islander (1992-1995)
432	Other Asian or Pacific Islander (1996)

433	Other Asian or Pacific Islander (1997-1998)
434	Other Asian (1999 forward)
500	Other Race
510	Other Race (1963-1977)
520	Other Race (1978)
530	Other Race (1979-1991)
540	Other Race (1992-1995)
550	Other Race (1996)
560	Other Race (1997-1998)
570	Other Race (1999-2002)
580	Primary Race not releasable
600	Multiple Race, No Primary Race Selected
610	Multiple Race, including Asian, excluding Black and White
611	Multiple Race, including Asian and Black, excluding White
612	Multiple Race, including Asian and White, excluding Black
613	Multiple Race, including Black, excluding Asian and White
614	Multiple Race, including Black and White, excluding Asian
615	Multiple Race, including White, excluding Asian and Black
616	Multiple Race, including Asian, White, and Black
617	Multiple Race, excluding Asian, White, and Black
900	Unknown
970	Unknown-refused
980	Unknown-not ascertained
990	Unknown (1997 forward: Don't know)

Variable: "HEALTH"

Name:	HEALTH
Label:	Health status
Variable Text:	HEALTH rates an individual's general health (as self-reported by the person in question) on a five-point Likert scale, ranging from "excellent" to "poor." HEALTH is one of a set of variables comprising the Veteran's RAND 12-item scale measuring self-rated health, collected on the Adult Self-Administered Questionnaire (SAQ). For related variables and more information, please see ADDAYA.
Concept:	Health Status Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	89
End Position:	89
Width:	1
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
0	NIU
1	Excellent
2	Very Good
3	Good
4	Fair
5	Poor
7	Unknown-refused
8	Unknown-not ascertained
9	Unknown-don't know

Variable: "USUALPL"

Name:	USUALPL
Label:	Has usual place for medical care
Variable Text:	For all persons eligible for the Access to Care section (ACCESSELIG), USUALPL indicates whether they have a particular doctor's office, clinic, health center, or other place they usually go if they are sick or need advice about their health. USUALPL is collected as part of the Access to Care section, which gathers information on usual source of care for all family members, characteristics of usual source of care providers, and barriers family members have faced in obtaining needed health care. Please see ACCESSELIG for more information on the Access to Care section. IPUMS MEPS reports the universe for each variable based on a thorough review of the original MEPS documentation. Investigating the data may reveal cases that do not meet the stated universe. Users are encouraged to validate universes for their analyses. Related Variables USUALPL begins a series of variables about why the respondent does not have a usual source of care. In addition to USUALPL, the following questions are asked: WHYNOUSLPL: Main reason has no particular place for sick care NOUSLYER: Why no usual source of care: Uses hospital/ER/clinic NOUSLYDIFF: Why no usual source of care: Different places for different needs NOUSLYDR: Why no usual source of care: Looking for new doctor NOUSLYEXP: Why no usual source of care: Medical care too expensive NOUSLYFRFAM: Why no usual source of care: Doctor is self, friend, or family member NOUSLYHLTH: Why no usual source of care: Reason related to health NOUSLYINCHG: Why no usual source of care: Insurance charge NOUSLYINRSN: Why no usual source of care: Reason related to insurance NOUSLYJOB: Why no usual source of care: Reason related to job NOUSLYMOVE: Why no usual source of care: Recently moved to area NOUSLYNOINS: Why no usual source of care: No health insurance NOUSLYNONE: Why no usual source of care: No other reason NOUSLYSELF: Why no usual source of care: Self treat NOUSLYTRANS: Why no usual source of care: Reasons related to time and transportation NOUSLYWORK: Why no usual source of care: Receive care at work NOUSLYREFDR: Why no usual source of care: Refuse to go to the doctor NOUSLYDKWHER: Why no usual source of care: Doesn't know where to go NOUSLYDRMOV: Why no usual source of care: Previous doctor moved or is unavailable NOUSLYFAR: Why no usual source of care: Care too far away or inconvenient

	NOUSLYLANG: Why no usual source of care: Speak a different language NOUSLYNOLIKE: Why no usual source of care: Doesn't like doctors NOUSLYNONEED: Why no usual source of care: Doesn't need doctor NOUSLYOTH: Why no usual source of care: Other reason
Concept:	Usual Source of Care Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	90
End Position:	90
Width:	1
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
0	NIU
1	There is no place or No
2	Yes, has a usual place or Yes
3	There is more than one place
7	Unknown-refused
8	Unknown-not ascertained
9	Unknown-don't know

Variable: "HINOTCOV"

Name:	HINOTCOV
Label:	Has no health insurance (excluding single service plans)

Variable Text:	For all persons, HINOTCOV indicates whether the individual was not covered by health insurance at any time in the current calendar year. If an individual indicates not being covered by any of the forms of health insurance listed below, they are set to "Yes, has no coverage." If they indicate being covered by at least one of those methods for any length of time during the current calendar year, they are marked as "No, has coverage." An individual's response to other health insurance variables determines their health insurance coverage status. The variables HIPRIVATE, HICHAMPANY, HIMACHIP, HIMCARE, HIOTHGOVA, and HIOTHGOVB indicate whether an individual was covered by private health insurance, military health insurance, Medicaid and/or SCHIP, Medicare, or other public health insurance at any point during the current calendar year.
Concept:	General Coverage Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	91
End Position:	92
Width:	2
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
00	NIU
01	No, has coverage
02	Yes, has no coverage
09	Unknown/refused

Variable: "HIPRIVATE"

Name:	HIPRIVATE
Label:	Has any private health insurance
Variable Text:	For all persons, HIPRIVATE is an annual summary variable that indicates whether the person had private health insurance coverage from any source, including TRICARE/CHAMPVA, for at least one day during the calendar year. This variable was

	constructed by AHRQ staff based on the values of the corresponding 12 month-by-month private health insurance coverage variables (PRIJA-PRIDE).
Concept:	General Coverage Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	93
End Position:	94
Width:	2
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
01	No
02	Yes

Variable: "HIMACHIP"

Name:	HIMACHIP
Label:	Covered by Medicaid and/or SCHIP
Variable Text:	HIMACHIP indicates whether the person currently had health insurance coverage through public assistance, Medicaid, or a State Children's Health Insurance Program (SCHIP). This variable was constructed by AHRQ staff based on the values of the corresponding 12 month-by-month Medicaid health insurance coverage variables (MAJA-MADE). Definitions Family respondents were asked about public assistance, Medicaid, or SCHIP coverage during the Health Insurance portion of the questionnaire. Respondents were asked "Let's talk (again) about all the health insurance coverage the family may have to help pay for the costs of medical care (since {START DATE}/between {START DATE} and {END DATE}}." Respondents were prompted to retrieve any insurance cards or identifying information to help answer questions about health insurance coverage. Respondents were asked "{Medicaid/{STATE NAME FOR MEDICAID}} or {STATE CHIP NAME} are state programs that pay for health care for persons in need. People covered by {Medicaid/{STATE NAME FOR MEDICAID}} or {STATE CHIP NAME} may have a (piece of paper/card) that looks something like this. At any time {since {START DATE}/between {START DATE} and {END DATE}}, has anyone in the family been covered by {Medicaid/{STATE NAME FOR MEDICAID}} or {STATE CHIP

	NAME}?" If respondents needed more explanation of Medicaid or SCHIP, they were told: "Medicaid is a federally-assisted, state-administered program that offers health benefits to low income persons on public assistance. The program also may cover the aged, the blind, and the disabled who are in financial need. Medicaid may be known by different names in different states. The Children's Health Insurance Program (SCHIP) is a program which gives each state permission to offer health insurance for children, up to age 19, who are not already insured and for uninsured families with limited income and resources who earn too much to qualify for Medicaid. SCHIP is a state administered program and may be known by different names in different states."
Concept:	General Coverage Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	95
End Position:	95
Width:	1
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
1	No
2	Yes

Variable: "ARTHGLUPEV"

Name:	ARTHGLUPEV
Label:	Ever told had arthritis/rheumatoid arthritis/gout/lupus/fibromyalgia
Variable Text:	ARTHGLUPEV identifies persons over age 17 who have been diagnosed with arthritis. Respondents were asked if they have ever been told "by a doctor or other health professional that (PERSON) had arthritis?" Beginning in Panel 12, ARTHGLUPEV was included as a Priority Condition in the Priority Conditions Enumeration (PE) section. The PE section was asked in its entirety in Round 1 for all current or institutionalized persons, and in Rounds 2 and 4 for only new reporting unit members. In Rounds 3 and 5, the specific condition questions (except joint pain and chronic bronchitis) were asked only if the person had not reported the condition in a previous round; the joint pain and chronic bronchitis questions were asked in Rounds 3

	and 5 for all current or institutionalized persons aged 18 or older, regardless of Round 1, Round 2, and Round 4 responses. The conditions included in the PE section are: High blood pressure, including multiple diagnoses Heart disease (including coronary heart disease, angina, myocardial infarction, and other unspecified heart disease) Stroke Emphysema Chronic Bronchitis High cholesterol, including the age of diagnosis Cancer Diabetes Joint pain Arthritis Asthma Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder/Attention Deficit Disorder (ADHD/ADD) These conditions were selected because of their relatively high prevalence, and because generally accepted standards for appropriate clinical care have been developed. Beginning with Panel 12, condition data were collected at the person-by-round level (indicating if the person was ever diagnosed with the condition) and at the condition level. If the person reported having been diagnosed with a condition, the person-by-round variable was set to '1' (Yes) and a condition record for that medical condition was created.
Concept:	Other Conditions Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	96
End Position:	96
Width:	1
Variable Format:	numeric

Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
0	NIU
1	No
2	Yes
7	Unknown-refused
8	Unknown-not ascertained
9	Unknown-don't know

Variable: "CANCEREV"

Name:	CANCEREV
Label:	Ever told had cancer
Variable Text:	For persons ages 18 and older who were living at the time of the Round 1 interview, CANCEREV identifies respondents who have been diagnosed with cancer. Respondents were asked if they have ever been told "by a doctor or other health professional that (PERSON) had cancer or a malignancy of any kind?" Beginning in Panel 12, CANCEREV was included as a Priority Condition in the Priority Conditions Enumeration (PE) section. For more information about how the panel design of the MEPS impacts data collection, please see the MEPS Panel Design user note. The PE section was asked in its entirety in Round 1 for all current or institutionalized persons, and in Rounds 2 and 4 only for new reporting unit members. In Rounds 3 and 5, the specific condition questions (except joint pain and chronic bronchitis) were asked only if the person had not reported the condition in a previous round; the joint pain and chronic bronchitis questions were asked in Rounds 3 and 5 for all current or institutionalized persons aged 18 or older, regardless of Round 1, Round 2, and Round 4 responses. However, beginning in 2017, the PE section is no longer asked in Round 5. The conditions included in the PE section are: High blood pressure, including multiple diagnoses (HYPERTENEV) Heart disease (including coronary heart disease, angina, myocardial infarction, and other unspecified heart disease) (CHEARTDIEV) Stroke (STROKEV) Emphysema (EMPHYSEMEV) Chronic Bronchitis High cholesterol, including the age of diagnosis (CHOLHIGHEV, CHOLHIGHAGE)

	Cancer Diabetes (DIABETICEV) Joint pain Arthritis (ARTHGLUPEV) Asthma (ASTHMAEV) Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder/Attention Deficit Disorder (ADHD/ADD) (ADDEV) These conditions were selected because of their relatively high prevalence, and because generally accepted standards for appropriate clinical care have been developed. Beginning with Panel 12, condition data were collected at the person-by-round level (indicating if the person was ever diagnosed with the condition) and at the condition level. If the person reported having been diagnosed with a condition, the person-by-round variable was set to '1' (Yes) and a condition record for that medical condition was created.
Concept:	Cancer Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	97
End Position:	97
Width:	1
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
0	NIU
1	No
2	Yes
7	Unknown-refused
8	Unknown-not ascertained
9	Unknown-don't know

Variable: "CHEARTDIEV"

Name:	CHEARTDIEV
Label:	Ever told had coronary heart disease
Variable Text:	CHEARTDIEV identifies persons over age 17 who have been diagnosed with coronary heart disease. Respondents were asked if they have ever been told "by a doctor or other health professional that (PERSON) had coronary heart disease?" Beginning in Panel 12, CHEARTDIEV was included as a Priority Condition in the Priority Conditions Enumeration (PE) section. The PE section was asked in its entirety in Round 1 for all current or institutionalized persons, and in Rounds 2 and 4 for only new reporting unit members. In Rounds 3 and 5, the specific condition questions (except joint pain and chronic bronchitis) were asked only if the person had not reported the condition in a previous round; the joint pain and chronic bronchitis questions were asked in Rounds 3 and 5 for all current or institutionalized persons aged 18 or older, regardless of Round 1, Round 2, and Round 4 responses. The conditions included in the PE section are: • High blood pressure, including multiple diagnoses • Heart disease (including coronary heart disease, angina, myocardial infarction, and other unspecified heart disease) • Stroke • Emphysema • Chronic Bronchitis • High cholesterol, including the age of diagnosis • Cancer • Diabetes • Joint pain • Arthritis • Asthma • Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder/Attention Deficit Disorder (ADHD/ADD) These conditions were selected because of their relatively high prevalence, and because generally accepted standards for appropriate clinical care have been developed. Beginning with Panel 12, condition data were collected at the person-by-round level (indicating if the person was ever diagnosed with the condition) and at the condition level. If the person reported having been diagnosed with a condition, the person-by-round variable was set to '1' (Yes) and a condition record for that medical condition was created.
Concept:	Other Conditions Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	98
End Position:	98
Width:	1
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0
Categories	

Value	Label
0	NIU
1	No
2	Yes
7	Unknown--refused
8	Unknown--not ascertained
9	Unknown--don't know

Variable: "DIABETICEV"

Name:	DIABETICEV
Label:	Ever told had diabetes
Variable Text:	DIABETICEV identifies persons over age 17 who have been diagnosed with diabetes, other than during pregnancy. Respondents were asked if, other than during pregnancy, they have ever been told "by a doctor or other health professional that (PERSON) had diabetes or sugar diabetes?" Beginning in Panel 12, DIABETICEV was included as a Priority Condition in the Priority Conditions Enumeration (PE) section. The PE section was asked in its entirety in Round 1 for all current or institutionalized persons, and in Rounds 2 and 4 for only new reporting unit members. In Rounds 3 and 5, the specific condition questions (except joint pain and chronic bronchitis) were asked only if the person had not reported the condition in a previous round; the joint pain and chronic bronchitis questions were asked in Rounds 3 and 5 for all current or institutionalized persons aged 18 or older, regardless of Round 1, Round 2, and Round 4 responses. The conditions included in the PE section are: • High blood pressure, including multiple diagnoses • Heart disease (including coronary heart disease, angina, myocardial infarction, and other unspecified heart disease) • Stroke • Emphysema • Chronic Bronchitis • High cholesterol, including the age of diagnosis • Cancer • Diabetes • Joint pain • Arthritis • Asthma • Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder/Attention Deficit Disorder (ADHD/ADD) These conditions were selected because of their relatively high prevalence, and because generally accepted standards for appropriate clinical care have been developed. Beginning with Panel 12, condition data were collected at the person-by-round level (indicating if the person was ever diagnosed with the condition) and at the condition level. If the person reported having been diagnosed with a condition, the person-by-round variable was set to '1' (Yes) and a condition record for that medical condition was created.
Concept:	Other Conditions Variables -- PERSON

Start Position:	99
End Position:	99
Width:	1
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
0	NIU
1	No or not mentioned
2	Yes or mentioned
3	Borderline
7	Unknown-refused
8	Unknown-not ascertained
9	Unknown-don't know

Variable: "HEARTATTEV"

Name:	HEARTATTEV
Label:	Ever told had heart attack
Variable Text:	HEARTATTEV identifies persons over age 17 who have had a heart attack. Respondents were asked if they have ever been told "by a doctor or other health professional that (PERSON) had a heart attack, also called myocardial infarction or MI?" Beginning in Panel 12, HEARTATTEV was included as a Priority Condition in the Priority Conditions Enumeration (PE) section. The PE section was asked in its entirety in Round 1 for all current or institutionalized persons, and in Rounds 2 and 4 for only new reporting unit members. In Rounds 3 and 5, the specific condition questions (except joint pain and chronic bronchitis) were asked only if the person had not reported the condition in a previous round; the joint pain and chronic bronchitis questions were asked in Rounds 3 and 5 for all current or institutionalized persons aged 18 or older, regardless of Round 1, Round 2, and Round 4 responses. The conditions included in the PE section are:

	• High blood pressure, including multiple diagnoses • Heart disease (including coronary heart disease, angina, myocardial infarction, and other unspecified heart disease) • Stroke • Emphysema • Chronic Bronchitis • High cholesterol, including the age of diagnosis • Cancer • Diabetes • Joint pain • Arthritis • Asthma • Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder/Attention Deficit Disorder (ADHD/ADD) These conditions were selected because of their relatively high prevalence, and because generally accepted standards for appropriate clinical care have been developed. Beginning with Panel 12, condition data were collected at the person-by-round level (indicating if the person was ever diagnosed with the condition) and at the condition level. If the person reported having been diagnosed with a condition, the person-by-round variable was set to '1' (Yes) and a condition record for that medical condition was created.
Concept:	Other Conditions Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	100
End Position:	100
Width:	1
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
0	NIU
1	No
2	Yes
7	Unknown--refused
8	Unknown--not ascertained
9	Unknown--don't know

Variable: "PHQDEP"

Name:	PHQDEP
Label:	Feeling down, depressed, or hopeless: past two weeks
Variable Text:	For adults aged 18 and older, PHQDEP indicates how often the respondent felt down, depressed, or hopeless in the last two weeks. PHQDEP is part of the PHQ-2 depression scale. For more information on the PHQ-2, please see PHQ2.
Concept:	Adult Mental Health Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	101
End Position:	101
Width:	1
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
0	Not at all
1	Several days
2	More than half the days
3	Nearly every day
6	NIU
7	Unknown-refused
8	Unknown-not ascertained
9	Unknown-don't know

Variable: "EXPTOT"

Name:	EXPTOT

Label:	Annual total of direct health care payments
Variable Text:	For all persons, EXPTOT captures the sum of direct payments for care provided during the year, including out-of-pocket payments and payments by private insurance, Medicaid, Medicare, and other sources. Payments for over-the-counter drugs and indirect payments not related to specific medical events, such as Medicaid Disproportionate Share and Medicare Direct Medical Education subsidies, are not included in this amount. For more information on how MEPS collects expenditure data, please refer to our user note on medical expenditures. Related variables Variables related to total annual health care expenditures by source of payment, total annual health care expenditures by type of medical service, and total annual health care charges are also available. Please refer to our user note on expenditures for a list of these variables.
Concept:	Total Expenditures Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	102
End Position:	108
Width:	7
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0
Coder Instructions:	CodesEXPTOT is a 6-digit numeric variable.

Variable: "EREXPTOT"

Name:	EREXPTOT
Label:	Annual total of direct health care payments for emergency room visits
Variable Text:	For all persons, EREXPTOT captures the sum of direct payments for care provided during the year for all visits to emergency room medical providers, including out-of-pocket payments and payments by private insurance, Medicaid, Medicare, and other sources. Payments for over-the-counter drugs and indirect payments not related to specific medical events, such as Medicaid Disproportionate Share and Medicare Direct Medical Education subsidies, are not included in this amount. For more information on how MEPS collects expenditure data, please refer to our user note on medical expenditures. Note that hospitals usually include expenses associated with emergency room visits that immediately result in an inpatient stay with the charges and payments for the inpatient stay. Therefore, to avoid the potential for double counting when imputing missing expenses, separately reported facility expenditures for emergency room visits that were identified in the Medical Provider Component (MPC) as directly linked to an inpatient stay were included as part of the inpatient stay only (see HPCHGTOT and HPFCHT). This strategy to avoid double counting resulted in $0 facility expenditures for these emergency room visits (but there still may be associated separately-billing doctor expenses). However, these $0 emergency room visits are still counted as separate visits in the utilization variable

	ERTOTVIS.Related variables Variables related to total annual health care expenditures by source of payment, total annual health care expenditures by type of medical service, and total annual health care charges are also available. Please refer to our user note on expenditures for a list of these variables.
Concept:	Emergency Room Expenditures Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	109
End Position:	114
Width:	6
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Variable: "HPTOTDIS"

Name:	HPTOTDIS
Label:	Annual total number of hospital discharges
Variable Text:	For all persons, HPTOTDIS captures the total number of hospital discharges the person had during the current calendar year. HPTOTDIS includes hospitalizations where the person was discharged the same day that they were admitted ("zero-night stays," ZNTOTVIS) and hospitalizations where the person spent one or more nights in the hospital before being discharged. To obtain the total number of hospitalizations where persons spent at least one night in the hospital, analysts can subtract ZNTOTVIS from HPTOTDIS.
Concept:	Hospitalizations Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	115
End Position:	120
Width:	6
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Variable: "DVEXPTOT"

Name:	DVEXPTOT
Label:	Sum of expenditures for dental care received during the year
Variable Text:	For all persons, DVEXPTOT captures the sum of direct payments for dental care, including care provided by general dentists, dental hygienists, dental technicians, dental surgeons, orthodontists, endodontists, and periodontists provided during the year, including out-of-pocket payments and payments by private insurance, Medicaid, Medicare, and other sources. Payments for over-the-counter drugs and indirect payments not related to specific medical events, such as Medicaid Disproportionate Share and Medicare Direct Medical Education subsidies, are not included in this amount. For more information on how MEPS collects expenditure data, please refer to our user note on medical expenditures. For a small proportion of sample persons, the sum of the general dentist (DVGTOTVIS) and orthodontist visit (DVOTOTVIS) variables may not be equal to the total number of dental visits. This result can only occur for persons who were reported to have seen both a general dentist and orthodontist in the same visit(s). When this occurred, expenditures for the visit were included as orthodontist expenses (DVOEXTOT) but not as general dentist expenses (DVGEXTOT).Related variables Variables related to total annual health care expenditures by source of payment, total annual health care expenditures by type of medical service, and total annual health care charges are also available. Please refer to our user note on expenditures for a list of these variables.
Concept:	Dental Expenditures Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	121
End Position:	126
Width:	6
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Variable: "ADPALS"

Name:	ADPALS
Label:	Accomplished less because of physical health: past 4 weeks
Variable Text:	For adults aged 18 and older, ADPALS indicates how much of the time in the last four weeks the respondent accomplished less than they would like as a result of their physical health. Beginning in 2017, MEPS reversed the order of the response categories in the original variable. IPUMS MEPS staff recoded this variable so that response categories are consistent across all years. This may require users to recode certain years of data to calculate the physical component summary (PCS) and mental component summary (MCS) scores. ADPALS is one of a set of variables comprising the Veteran's RAND 12-item scale measuring

	self-rated health, collected on the Adult Self-Administered Questionnaire (SAQ). For related variables and more information, please see ADDAYA.
Concept:	Adult Mental Health Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	127
End Position:	127
Width:	1
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
0	None of the time
1	A little of the time
2	Some of the time
3	Most of the time
4	All of the time
6	NIU
7	Unknown-refused
8	Unknown-not ascertained
9	Unknown-don't know

Variable: "PHQ2"

Name:	PHQ2
Label:	PHQ-2 depression screen summary score

Variable Text:	For persons eligible for the Self-Administered Questionnaire (SAQELIG), PHQ2 reports the person's summary score on the Patient Health Questionnaire (PHQ-2), a screening measure for depression. The score reported in PHQ2, ranging from 0 through 6, summarizes responses to two component variables: PHQINTR: during the past two weeks, bothered by having little interest or pleasure in doing things, and PHQDEP: during the past two weeks, bothered by feeling down, depressed, or hopeless. The higher the value on PHQ2, the greater the person's tendency towards depression is. Kroenke et al. (2003) suggest a score of 3 as the optimal cut point for depression screening purposes. For more information, refer to Kroenke, K., Spitzer, R.L., and Williams, J.B. (2003). The Patient Health Questionnaire-2: Validity of a two-item depressive screener. Medical Care 41: 1284-1292.
Concept:	Adult Mental Health Variables -- PERSON
Start Position:	128
End Position:	129
Width:	2
Variable Format:	numeric
Implied Decimal Places:	0

Categories

Value	Label
00	
01	
02	
03	
04	
05	
06	

96	NIU
98	Unknown-not ascertained